

Tentative General Schedule Criteria – 2020

- Season opens April 9, closes on September 7, and our All-Star Break (in **JACKSON**) will take place at the end of the first half (3-day break)
- **Divisions will change in 2020** – North: BIR, CHA, JXN, **MAD (Madison, AL)**, TNS (Mobile)
South: BLX, JAX, MIS, **MTG**, PNS
- We will play a 140-game schedule in a split season format, with 70 games per half
- Equalize Fridays and Saturdays so each club has **22** weekend dates
- All games played on the Sunday before the All-Star Break should begin no later than 3 p.m. EDT / 2 p.m. CDT
- Half of our clubs should be home on July 3, the other half on July 4 – short trips preferred between cities (In 2020, July 3 is on Friday, July 4 is on Saturday)
- Trips over 500 miles must utilize an Off Day or get a variance from Farm Director
- No minor league club shall be scheduled, or rescheduled if practical, to play more than 30 consecutive dates without an off day
- In general, do not schedule more than two 10-game homestands or road trips per season, AND prefer no Off Days in middle of 10-game road trips or 10-game homestands
- Stay with basic 5-game format, with the option of utilizing 2-, 3-, 4-game series with our short trip clubs if needed. All affected clubs would prefer short series involving clubs within 150 miles of each other if it helps reduce 10-game homestands
- Scheduling 4- or 6-game series ok “here and there” to make schedule work better ok – but not preferred
- Most clubs can live with 1-2 variances, if necessary (except Biloxi – Brewers will not allow any variances)
- Southern League clubs may contain maximum of 2 scheduled doubleheaders per half, except may not be scheduled during final 20 days of a season or half. Additional doubleheaders must have prior permission of Farm Directors of both clubs. No split doubleheaders may be scheduled without waivers
- Each club must play every other club in the same division at least once in each half
- Each club must play every other club in the opposite division at least once per season at their home club
- In general, our clubs would prefer to play on Memorial Day (May 25) and Father’s Day (June 21); but not on Mother’s Day (May 10); or Easter (April 12), unless necessary for schedule
- If possible, visiting clubs should end their season within reasonable driving distance to home city
- Contracted* (“protected dates”) shall be respected. Requested dates, on the other hand, are not the priority, but may be scheduled where reasonable and if they do not negatively impact another club

*Contracted dates are those dates that have been set forth in a club’s stadium lease agreement between the club and the stadium authority, and/or have received Southern League approval for those dates, each year, before the schedule maker commences work on the schedule. While clubs may request certain dates for community or other events during the baseball season, these dates are not “protected” dates and will not be granted if they would negatively impact another club or would interfere with the league’s ability to prepare a fair schedule for all ten clubs as a whole.

All-Star — July 3/4 = 9 days.

2020 - Protected & Preferred Date Requests Worksheet for Clubs

Biloxi	1. HOME July 3
	2. <i>No 10-game homestand in August</i>
Birmingham	1. AWAY May 19-24 – SEC Tournament
	2. <i>Prefer HOME July 3</i>
Chattanooga	1. AWAY June 5-13 – Riverbend Festival
	2. <i>N/A</i>
Jackson	1. AWAY Opening Series @ Jacksonville ² + alt day?
	2. AWAY 2 nd Series of Season, if possible
	3. HOME BEFORE ALL-STAR GAME IN JUNE* or away for both?
Jacksonville	1. HOME July 3
	2. AWAY April 24, 25, 26 (weekend-long concert at Sports Complex)
Madison**	1. HOME July 4
	2. AWAY <u>Opening Series</u>
Mississippi	1. AWAY May 12-17 MHSAA Baseball Tournament
	2. AWAY April 21 – Governor's Cup
Montgomery**	1. AWAY May 19-25 Sunbelt Conference Tournament
	2. AWAY Last Series of Season
Pensacola	1. AWAY last series of season
	2. AWAY May 1-5
Tennessee	1. AWAY April 26-30 SAC Tournament
	2. HOME July 3

*The team hosting the All-Star Game has the "extra" option of requesting to be either HOME or AWAY before the All-Star Game, and should be granted.

**Starting with the 2020 season, Madison will be in the North Division, and Montgomery will move to the South Division.

NOTE: The 2nd request is NOT guaranteed, but may be granted if it does not impact another team's schedule.

NOTE: If at all possible, the following teams should open 1st series AWAY: Jackson, Madison, Tennessee. Jacksonville prefers to open 1st series at HOME (vs. Jackson). (The other 6 teams have no preference.)

NOTE: The following teams prefer to be HOME for July 3: Biloxi, Birmingham, Jacksonville, Tennessee. The following team prefers to be HOME for July 4: Madison. (The other 5 teams have no preference.)

